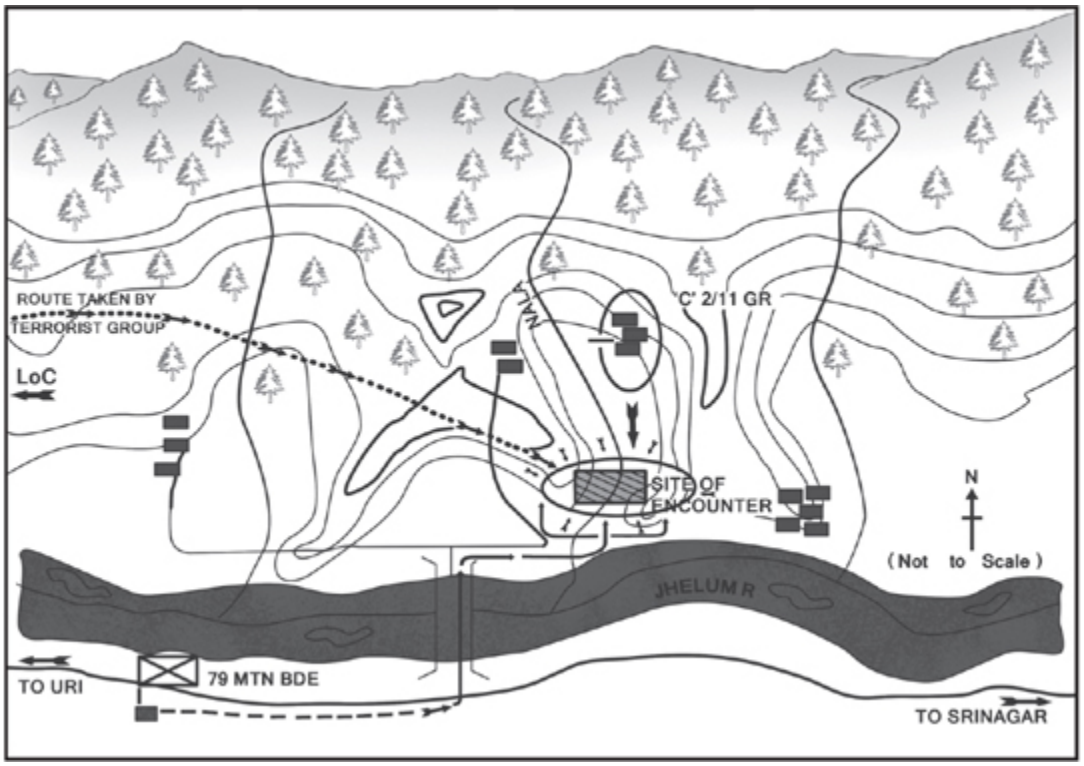


Sketch 12.1: Encounter with terrorists during Operation Mousetrap, 1991.

We landed at Badami Bagh, the cantonment of Srinagar, at around 4 p.m. Once again I was put into the ambulance, and taken straight to the military hospital. I was feeling very weak and exhausted and in shock, because of substantial loss of blood and the pain. The effect of the morphine was still there, though my leg felt dead as a log of wood! Soon we arrived at 92 Base Hospital and I was wheeled on the stretcher directly to the operation theatre. The surgical specialist, Lieutenant Colonel Brij Mohan Nagpal, opened the field dressing and asked the paramedic to get an X-Ray done. Fortunately, there was no bone injury, thereby making the surgery less complicated. General anaesthesia was then administered to me. Once tranquillized, I lost consciousness. Later, the nursing officer told me that the doctors took two-and-a-half hours to complete the surgery. They did it with great precision and professionalism, as is their wont, and I can swear on that now. After the operation, I was taken to the intensive care unit.